

## CURRICULUM SEQUENCE

# Unit 1: Short Stories and Emotive Description

5e International Section (UK Year 8 equivalent)

6 weeks - 42 lessons - 55 minutes each

|                         |                                                                                                |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>CORE READING</b>     | All Summer in a Day - The Landlady - The Monkey's Paw - The Veldt                              |
| <b>UNIT TASKS</b>       | Unseen fiction comprehension (Coef. 2) - descriptive writing (Coef. 1)                         |
| <b>DESIGN PRINCIPLE</b> | Read whole stories, analyse precise choices, then transfer the craft into independent writing. |

**Bottom line**

Use the literary anthology and consolidated close-reading extracts as the backbone. Use the numbered skill sheets only as short scaffolds. Most of the pack is an archive, not a curriculum.

## Unit at a glance

This sequence deliberately extends the original outline. Four complete stories provide breadth and depth; analytical reading is repeatedly converted into short written responses; descriptive writing grows directly from the language studied rather than appearing as an unrelated bolt-on week.

| Week | Reading / writing spine      | Primary progression                                                 | Major evidence                                   |
|------|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | All Summer in a Day          | Annotation, explicit/implicit meaning, setting, mood, character     | Cold response + analytical paragraph             |
| 2    | The Landlady                 | Prediction, inference, foreshadowing, irony, tension                | Close-reading paragraph + interpretation seminar |
| 3    | The Monkey's Paw             | Gothic convention, symbolism, cause/effect, structure, pace         | Comparative paragraph                            |
| 4    | The Veldt                    | Theme, author purpose, sensory imagery, comparison and debate       | Timed transfer response                          |
| 5    | Emotive descriptive writing  | Imagery, sentence control, punctuation, paragraph cohesion, editing | Descriptive writing assessment - Coef. 1         |
| 6    | Unseen fiction comprehension | Retrieval, inference, vocabulary in context, analysis, evaluation   | Reading assessment - Coef. 2                     |

## Curriculum mapping - England KS3 English

| Ref | KS3 entitlement used in this unit                                                           | Where it is made visible                                                               |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| R1  | Read increasingly challenging fiction from varied traditions.                               | Four complete stories plus unfamiliar literary extracts.                               |
| R2  | Understand challenging texts: vocabulary, inference, evidence and secure comprehension.     | Annotation routines, evidence selection, cold reading and unseen assessment.           |
| R3  | Know purpose, audience and context; recognise conventions and how meaning is shaped.        | Genre teaching, author-purpose tasks and thematic interpretation.                      |
| R4  | Study setting, plot, characterisation, viewpoint and the effects of language and structure. | Every anchor story; analytical paragraph routine.                                      |
| R5  | Make critical comparisons across texts.                                                     | Weeks 3-4 comparative discussion and writing.                                          |
| W1  | Write accurately, fluently and imaginatively for purpose and audience.                      | Descriptive portfolio and formal writing task.                                         |
| W2  | Select vocabulary, grammar, literary and rhetorical devices deliberately.                   | Sensory imagery, figurative language, sentence rhythm, punctuation and power of three. |
| W3  | Plan, draft, edit and proofread, evaluating effectiveness.                                  | Week 5 rehearsal, feedback, redrafting and proofreading.                               |
| S1  | Use discussion, explanation, debate and performance to develop ideas.                       | Seminars, paired rehearsal, dramatic reading and technology debate.                    |

### Current curriculum note

This maps to the statutory KS3 English programme currently published by the Department for Education. A replacement curriculum is planned for publication in spring 2027 and teaching from September 2028; remap when the final document exists.

Reference: Department for Education, English programmes of study: key stage 3 - <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/national-curriculum-in-england-english-programmes-of-study>

# Resource audit: what stays

The decisions below refer to the supplied ZIP. 'Keep' does not mean 'teach every page'; it means the item earns a clear role in the sequence.

| Resource group                                                         | Decision                       | Best use                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Expanded-Best-Short-Stories-for-Middle-School.pdf                      | KEEP - core anthology          | Use The Landlady, The Monkey's Paw and The Veldt as complete anchor stories. Extract only the pages needed and check school reproduction permissions.                                            |
| 10 Short Stories.docx                                                  | KEEP - curated idea bank       | Use its link to All Summer in a Day for Week 1. Retain Thank You, Ma'am, The Scholarship Jacket and The Medicine Bag as future tonal/cultural alternatives. Refresh links before teaching.       |
| Close Reading 11-14 - consolidated TEST PASSAGES + ANSWERS             | KEEP - selective transfer bank | Prioritise The War of the Worlds, The Wind Singer, A Series of Unfortunate Events and Bee Season. Their literary language and question demand suit 5SI far better than the generic skill sheets. |
| Cooper: General Skills / Understanding / Analysing Language / Glossary | KEEP - teacher reference       | Mine the books for question stems, terminology and stretch tasks. Do not march students through the volumes page by page.                                                                        |
| The House in the Mist                                                  | KEEP - timed practice          | Use as the Week 6 mock only if the class has not previously seen it.                                                                                                                             |
| Power of 3 documents                                                   | KEEP THE CONCEPT - rebuild     | Reuse the definition and technique in Week 5, but present it in a cleaner teacher-made slide/example set.                                                                                        |
| 2023/2024 common assessment materials                                  | KEEP SECURE - moderation       | Use mark schemes and past papers to calibrate difficulty. Do not recycle as a live unseen task if any pupil may have encountered them.                                                           |

## Anthology triage

| Use                          | Texts                                                                              | Reason                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core                         | The Landlady; The Monkey's Paw; The Veldt                                          | High interpretive yield: atmosphere, inference, structure, symbolism, irony and theme.                                      |
| Stretch / independent choice | Harrison Bergeron; The Nine Billion Names of God; The Necklace; Third from the Sun | Excellent for satire, twist structure and comparative reading; better as choice or extension than another whole-class week. |
| Optional with content check  | Lamb to the Slaughter; The Lottery; The Most Dangerous Game                        | Strong literature, but violence and mature implications require a deliberate class decision.                                |
| Do not prioritise            | The Black Cat; The Cask of Amontillado; Sorry, Wrong Number; The Hitchhiker        | Either unnecessarily intense/archaic for this first unit or less directly useful than the chosen core.                      |

## Resource audit: adapt or archive

| Resource group                                            | Decision                    | Why / exception                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial class practice 1-20: text, activities and answers | ARCHIVE MOST                | The prose is generic, the questions are heavily multiple-choice, and the ceiling is too low for native/near-native students. Keep The Case, New Heights, Clock Watching and Bad Break only as 10-minute scaffold or catch-up tasks. |
| Comprehension SKILL sheets                                | TEACHER REFERENCE ONLY      | The definitions can support explanation, but separate skill sheets fragment reading into isolated labels. Teach the skills inside real stories.                                                                                     |
| Extension PPTs linked to the 1-20 series                  | DO NOT USE IN CORE          | They extend weak base texts and create unnecessary repetition. Salvage an individual slide only when it solves a specific gap.                                                                                                      |
| Introductory Activities PPTs                              | ADAPT, DO NOT PRESENT WHOLE | Useful sequencing ideas, but visually dated and too procedural for seven lessons a week. Rebuild the annotation routine in the IWB toolkit later.                                                                                   |
| ALL PREVIOUS - isolated page scans                        | ARCHIVE                     | These duplicate the consolidated Close Reading 11-14 passages and are cumbersome to assemble. Use the consolidated versions instead.                                                                                                |
| Visual and authentic texts - adverts                      | MOVE OUT OF UNIT            | Useful resources, wrong unit. Save for media/non-fiction study.                                                                                                                                                                     |
| John's Bright Idea / generic Close Reading Passage        | DO NOT USE                  | Low challenge and little literary payoff for this cohort.                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Harry Potter / Ollivander practice                        | OPTIONAL ENGAGEMENT ONLY    | Familiarity can distort inference and makes them poor formal unseen texts. Fine for a low-stakes lesson or cover work.                                                                                                              |
| Old Bee Season common tasks and duplicate question sheets | ARCHIVE / MODERATION        | Retain one clean extract, one clean question paper and one answer key; archive the rest to prevent version confusion.                                                                                                               |
| The Pedestrian                                            | DO NOT REUSE HERE           | It is strong, but it has already served as the Unit 0 diagnostic. Repetition would weaken the unseen/transfer principle.                                                                                                            |

### Housekeeping recommendation

Create four folders: 01 Core Stories, 02 Transfer Extracts, 03 Assessment Secure, 04 Archive. Copy only the selected files into the first two. Leave the ZIP untouched as the master archive.

**WEEK 1**

# Reading beneath the surface

Spine: All Summer in a Day - Ray Bradbury

Weekly aim: Establish a common close-reading routine and move quickly from literal comprehension to supported inference, setting, mood and character.

Pronote agenda summary

Students begin the short-story unit through Ray Bradbury's All Summer in a Day. They practise annotation, explicit and implicit comprehension, vocabulary in context, analysis of setting and mood, and a first evidence-based analytical paragraph.

## LESSON 1 | What makes a short story work?

Learning: Identify the compressed elements of short fiction and establish annotation expectations.

55-minute flow: 5 image/title prediction; 10 mini-teach on short-story form; 20 cold micro-fiction read; 15 annotate and rank useful marks; 5 exit definition.

Resource: Teacher micro-fiction + annotation key; Intro PPT ideas rebuilt.

Evidence: Baseline paragraph: What does the writer make us expect?

## LESSON 2 | First encounter

Learning: Read a complete story for gist while tracking shifts in mood and expectation.

55-minute flow: 5 retrieval warm-up; 8 context without spoilers; 27 read All Summer in a Day; 10 pair timeline; 5 one-sentence gist.

Resource: All Summer in a Day via the supplied 10 Short Stories link.

Evidence: Accurate six-event plot line and initial reaction.

## LESSON 3 | Explicit, implicit, inferred

Learning: Distinguish what the text states from what it implies and support inference precisely.

55-minute flow: 5 claim sort; 10 model inference chain; 22 evidence hunt; 13 inference ladder in pairs; 5 exit quotation.

Resource: Story text + teacher inference ladder.

Evidence: Three inference chains: evidence - inference - reasoning.

## LESSON 4 | Venus as emotional weather

Learning: Analyse how setting and sensory imagery create mood.

55-minute flow: 5 sensory recall; 10 mood vocabulary scale; 20 close annotation; 15 transform one neutral sentence; 5 exit effect statement.

Resource: Story text; optional The Case scaffold for selected pupils.

Evidence: One developed language-effect paragraph.

## LESSON 5 | Margot and the crowd

Learning: Explain characterisation through action, contrast, dialogue and group behaviour.

55-minute flow: 5 character continuum; 10 direct/indirect characterisation; 20 evidence stations; 15 hot-seat questioning; 5 judgement.

Resource: Story text + character evidence grid.

Evidence: Supported judgement on responsibility.

## LESSON 6 | Structure, delay and the ending

Learning: Track narrative sequencing and explain how delay shapes reader response.

55-minute flow: 5 reorder plot beats; 10 structure vocabulary; 20 tension graph; 15 ending discussion; 5 alternative title.

Resource: Story text; plot/tension graph.

Evidence: Annotated tension curve with two causal explanations.

## LESSON 7 | From idea to analytical paragraph

Learning: Write a coherent response using a precise claim, embedded evidence and explanation of effect.

55-minute flow: 5 weak/strong claim vote; 12 live model; 23 independent paragraph; 10 colour-code/edit; 5 self-score.

Resource: Model paragraph + success criteria.

Evidence: Formative analytical paragraph and target.

## WEEK 2

# Suspense and dangerous hospitality

Spine: The Landlady - Roald Dahl

Weekly aim: Develop prediction into disciplined inference and analyse foreshadowing, dramatic irony, word choice and sentence control.

Pronote agenda summary

Students study Roald Dahl's The Landlady, focusing on inference, foreshadowing, irony and the construction of suspense. They evaluate competing interpretations and write a close-reading response about how unease is created.

## LESSON 8 | The promise of the title

Learning: Make provisional predictions and revise them as evidence changes.

55-minute flow: 5 title/image prediction; 10 prediction rules; 25 read opening; 10 prediction audit; 5 confidence rating.

Resource: Expanded anthology - The Landlady, opening pages.

Evidence: Prediction log showing revision, not guessing.

## LESSON 9 | Read like a detective

Learning: Read to the end and identify details whose significance changes retrospectively.

55-minute flow: 5 recap; 28 complete reading; 12 clue collection; 5 silent ending response; 5 best clue.

Resource: Expanded anthology - complete story.

Evidence: Ranked clue list with brief justification.

## LESSON 10 | Billy Weaver: reader and victim

Learning: Analyse characterisation and explain the gap between Billy's reading and the reader's.

55-minute flow: 5 agree/disagree; 10 character methods; 20 quotation sort; 15 dramatic irony map; 5 judgement.

Resource: Story text + evidence cards.

Evidence: Claim on whether Billy is naive, polite or trapped.

## LESSON 11 | Foreshadowing without a spoiler siren

Learning: Explain how ordinary details accumulate into warning signs.

55-minute flow: 5 harmless/sinister sort; 10 foreshadowing model; 22 close read; 13 clue escalation line; 5 effect sentence.

Resource: Story text.

Evidence: Five clues sequenced from subtle to unmistakable.

## LESSON 12 | The language of unease

Learning: Analyse connotation, sentence length, repetition and punctuation in a short passage.

55-minute flow: 5 connotation scale; 12 teacher model; 20 paired annotation; 13 paragraph sprint; 5 exit edit.

Resource: Selected anthology passage; Cooper Part 3 as teacher reference.

Evidence: Timed analytical paragraph.

## LESSON 13 | What actually happened?

Learning: Build and challenge an interpretation using evidence and qualification.

55-minute flow: 5 four-corners verdict; 10 seminar preparation; 25 evidence-led seminar; 10 written counterclaim; 5 reflection.

Resource: Story text + seminar stems.

Evidence: Claim, counterclaim and final qualified judgement.

## LESSON 14 | Close-reading checkpoint

Learning: Sustain a structured response to a focused question under light time pressure.

55-minute flow: 5 decode question; 8 plan; 27 independent response; 10 edit against criteria; 5 target.

Resource: Question: How does Dahl make the boarding house increasingly disturbing?

Evidence: One-page formative response.

## WEEK 3

# Gothic consequence and narrative control

Spine: The Monkey's Paw - W. W. Jacobs

Weekly aim: Read a more linguistically demanding classic and connect atmosphere, symbol, causality, pacing and withheld information.

Pronote agenda summary

Students read W. W. Jacobs' The Monkey's Paw as a Gothic short story. They analyse atmosphere, symbolism, foreshadowing, cause and effect, pacing and the ambiguous ending, before comparing Jacobs' suspense with Dahl's.

## LESSON 15 | Entering the Gothic

Learning: Recognise Gothic conventions while avoiding a feature-spotting checklist.

55-minute flow: 5 atmosphere soundscape; 10 context and conventions; 23 read Part I; 12 convention/effect pairs; 5 prediction.

Resource: Expanded anthology - The Monkey's Paw, Part I.

Evidence: Three convention-effect explanations.

## LESSON 16 | A room against the storm

Learning: Explain how setting, contrast and sensory detail create foreboding.

55-minute flow: 5 setting sketch; 10 pathetic fallacy/contrast; 22 close annotation; 13 oral rehearsal; 5 effect sentence.

Resource: Opening passage; optional When Winter Turned Fierce as scaffold only.

Evidence: Developed analysis of inside/outside contrast.

## LESSON 17 | Object, warning, choice

Learning: Analyse the paw as a symbol and trace how warnings are framed.

55-minute flow: 5 object inference; 8 symbolism model; 25 re-read warnings; 12 responsibility continuum; 5 claim.

Resource: Part I.

Evidence: Symbolism note plus responsibility judgement.

## LESSON 18 | Cause, effect and the cost of a wish

Learning: Track causality and distinguish coincidence from supernatural interpretation.

55-minute flow: 5 causality chain; 25 read Part II; 10 evidence for two readings; 10 paired debate; 5 verdict.

Resource: Part II.

Evidence: Dual interpretation evidence table.

## LESSON 19 | Pace at the door

Learning: Analyse sentence length, repetition, dialogue and withheld information in the climax.

55-minute flow: 5 rhythm read-aloud; 25 read Part III; 10 pace annotation; 10 performance choices; 5 effect statement.

Resource: Part III.

Evidence: Annotated climax with three pace choices.

## LESSON 20 | The power of absence

Learning: Evaluate the ambiguous ending and explain why omission can be more powerful than explanation.

55-minute flow: 5 ending image; 10 ambiguity vocabulary; 20 interpretation groups; 15 evidence challenge; 5 final line.

Resource: Complete story.

Evidence: Qualified interpretation supported by two details.

## LESSON 21 | Comparative craft

Learning: Compare how Jacobs and Dahl create suspense through setting and information control.

55-minute flow: 5 comparison connectors; 10 comparative thesis model; 10 evidence planning; 25 write; 5 self-check.

Resource: The Monkey's Paw + The Landlady.

Evidence: Comparative paragraph using both texts.

## WEEK 4

# Speculative fiction and author purpose

Spine: The Veldt - Ray Bradbury

Weekly aim: Move beyond device identification to theme, viewpoint and author purpose, then transfer the full close-reading toolkit to unfamiliar prose.

Pronote agenda summary

Students study Bradbury's The Veldt, exploring sensory imagery, family conflict, technology, irony and author purpose. They compare methods across the unit, debate the story's warning and complete a timed close-reading transfer task.

## LESSON 22 | A perfect home?

Learning: Use setting details to infer values, relationships and emerging conflict.

55-minute flow: 5 smart-home quickwrite; 8 speculative-fiction frame; 27 read opening; 10 luxury/threat sort; 5 prediction.

Resource: Expanded anthology - The Veldt, opening.

Evidence: Inference paragraph on the house as more than setting.

## LESSON 23 | Who holds power?

Learning: Track conflict and changing power through dialogue, action and narrative detail.

55-minute flow: 5 power ranking; 25 continue reading; 10 relationship map; 10 evidence challenge; 5 shift statement.

Resource: The Veldt.

Evidence: Power map with two textual turning points.

## LESSON 24 | A room you can smell

Learning: Analyse multisensory imagery and personification, then imitate the method with control.

55-minute flow: 5 sensory retrieval; 10 close model; 20 annotation; 15 120-word imitation; 5 strongest sentence.

Resource: The Veldt + teacher model.

Evidence: Craft imitation using three senses and personification.

## LESSON 25 | Clues, denial and dramatic irony

Learning: Explain how foreshadowing and adult misreading position the reader.

55-minute flow: 5 clue recall; 10 irony recap; 20 clue network; 15 reader/parent comparison; 5 effect.

Resource: The Veldt.

Evidence: Evidence chain linking three clues.

## LESSON 26 | Warning, satire or nightmare?

Learning: Evaluate Bradbury's purpose without reducing the story to a single moral.

55-minute flow: 5 theme/moral sort; 10 purpose modelling; 20 evidence groups; 15 structured debate; 5 qualified thesis.

Resource: Complete story.

Evidence: Nuanced author-purpose thesis.

## LESSON 27 | Across the unit

Learning: Compare how two writers turn a safe place into a threatening one.

55-minute flow: 5 text selection; 10 comparative planning; 12 evidence retrieval; 23 comparative response; 5 review.

Resource: Choice of The Veldt, The Landlady, The Monkey's Paw or All Summer in a Day.

Evidence: Two-text comparative response.

## LESSON 28 | Timed transfer: unfamiliar fear

Learning: Apply retrieval, inference and language analysis to an unfamiliar literary extract.

55-minute flow: 5 read question map; 12 independent read/annotate; 28 timed answers; 7 review; 3 confidence score.

Resource: The War of the Worlds consolidated test passage.

Evidence: Marked mini-comprehension and reteach group data.

## WEEK 5

# From close reader to deliberate writer

Spine: Emotive descriptive writing

Weekly aim: Transfer studied craft into an original description with controlled imagery, sentence rhythm, punctuation, paragraphing and revision.

Pronote agenda summary

Students develop an emotive descriptive piece inspired by the unit's settings. They practise precise sensory imagery, figurative language, sentence rhythm, dashes and ellipses, the power of three, paragraph shaping, drafting and editing. The week ends with the formal descriptive writing task (Coef. 1).

## LESSON 29 | Steal like a writer

Learning: Identify transferable craft moves in mentor passages and explain their intended effects.

55-minute flow: 5 favourite line; 10 craft-move taxonomy; 20 mentor passage carousel; 15 imitation; 5 choose personal target.

Resource: Short extracts from the four core stories.

Evidence: Writer's toolkit of six purposeful moves.

## LESSON 30 | Concrete detail, real emotion

Learning: Create emotion through specific sensory detail rather than emotion labels.

55-minute flow: 5 show/tell sort; 10 specificity ladder; 20 five-senses drafting; 15 peer image test; 5 revise one line.

Resource: Teacher image prompts; no new copyrighted text needed.

Evidence: 150-word setting description with controlled mood.

## LESSON 31 | Figurative language that earns its keep

Learning: Use simile, metaphor and personification selectively and avoid mixed or decorative imagery.

55-minute flow: 5 repair bad imagery; 10 model; 20 image bank; 15 integrate and trim; 5 best comparison.

Resource: Mentor lines + teacher examples.

Evidence: Three coherent images serving one atmosphere.

## LESSON 32 | Rhythm, punctuation and power of three

Learning: Control sentence length, fragments, dashes, ellipses, repetition and tricolon for pace and emphasis.

55-minute flow: 5 read aloud; 12 sentence surgery; 18 guided transformations; 15 independent paragraph; 5 punctuation justification.

Resource: Power of 3 concept rebuilt; core-story climax excerpts.

Evidence: Paragraph annotated with purpose, not device names alone.

## LESSON 33 | Shape the reader's journey

Learning: Plan a description with a clear viewpoint, spatial movement and emotional shift.

55-minute flow: 5 compare plans; 10 paragraph architecture; 20 individual plan; 15 oral walkthrough; 5 final decision.

Resource: Assessment-style image/setting choices + planning frame.

Evidence: Complete plan with opening, shift, focal detail and closing image.

## LESSON 34 | Rehearsal and surgical editing

Learning: Draft under time pressure and edit for impact, cohesion and accuracy.

55-minute flow: 5 goal; 30 timed rehearsal; 8 silent edit; 8 feedback on two criteria; 4 next-step note.

Resource: Fresh practice stimulus + assessment criteria.

Evidence: Rehearsal sample and personal checklist.

## LESSON 35 | Unit task: descriptive writing

Learning: Produce an independent, coherent and technically controlled emotive description.

55-minute flow: 5 read/select stimulus; 8 plan; 37 write and proofread; 5 submit/reflection.

Resource: New visual or verbal stimulus; clean planning space; rubric.

Evidence: Formal descriptive writing assessment - Coef. 1.

## WEEK 6

# Unseen reading and independent transfer

Spine: Comprehension assessment preparation and completion

Weekly aim: Consolidate question-reading, evidence selection, inference, analysis and evaluation without coaching the final unseen text.

Pronote agenda summary

Students consolidate close-reading strategies using unfamiliar fiction extracts, complete a timed practice and respond to feedback. They then sit the formal unseen fiction comprehension assessment (Coef. 2) and finish the unit by reviewing progress and setting an individual reading target.

## LESSON 36 | Know what the question is buying

Learning: Identify command words, evidence expectations and efficient answer length.

55-minute flow: 5 command-word match; 12 question anatomy; 20 guided examples; 13 improve weak answers; 5 exit rule.

Resource: A Series of Unfortunate Events consolidated passage/questions.

Evidence: Question-type decision guide.

## LESSON 37 | Inference without invention

Learning: Select sufficient evidence and explain a defensible inference in own words.

55-minute flow: 5 evidence or guess; 10 inference model; 20 paired practice; 15 independent response; 5 audit.

Resource: The Wind Singer consolidated passage.

Evidence: Two precise inference responses.

## LESSON 38 | Mock: full-process rehearsal

Learning: Manage reading, annotation, question order and checking within a fixed time.

55-minute flow: 5 instructions; 42 timed mock; 8 reflection and collection.

Resource: The House in the Mist - only if genuinely unseen; otherwise Bee Season.

Evidence: Mock score by skill strand.

## LESSON 39 | Feedback clinic

Learning: Diagnose the cause of lost marks and correct answers using the relevant strategy.

55-minute flow: 8 whole-class patterns; 30 rotating clinics; 12 corrections; 5 individual target.

Resource: Mock responses + answer guidance.

Evidence: Correction sheet explaining why each change earns credit.

## LESSON 40 | Unit task: unseen fiction comprehension

Learning: Demonstrate independent comprehension and analysis of an unfamiliar prose passage.

55-minute flow: 5 instructions; 45 assessment; 5 final check and collection.

Resource: A newly selected unseen fiction passage and common paper; do not draw from any taught/practised text.

Evidence: Formal reading comprehension assessment - Coef. 2.

## LESSON 41 | Assessment debrief and repair

Learning: Understand strengths and misconceptions, then improve one response independently.

55-minute flow: 8 class trends; 12 model comparison; 20 DIRT correction; 10 paired explanation; 5 target.

Resource: Anonymised samples + marked assessments.

Evidence: One fully improved response and next-step target.

## LESSON 42 | What short stories taught us

Learning: Synthesise learning across reading and writing and articulate future transfer.

55-minute flow: 5 quotation recall; 15 story/craft concept map; 15 mini symposium; 15 portfolio reflection; 5 exit commitment.

Resource: Four core stories + student portfolio.

Evidence: Skills passport: secure, developing, next target.

## Assessment architecture

| Evidence                    | Timing  | Conditions                        | Assesses                                               | Use                     |
|-----------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Week 1 analytical paragraph | L7      | Supported                         | Inference + language analysis                          | Baseline/formative      |
| The Landlady response       | L14     | Lightly timed                     | Sustained close reading                                | Formative feedback      |
| Comparative response        | L21/L27 | Independent                       | Comparison + evidence                                  | Progress check          |
| Timed transfer              | L28     | Timed                             | Unfamiliar extract                                     | Grouping/reteach data   |
| Descriptive writing         | L35     | Independent; new stimulus         | Content, organisation, style, accuracy                 | Unit task - Coef. 1     |
| Mock comprehension          | L38     | Timed; unseen to class            | Full reading process                                   | Diagnostic before final |
| Unseen comprehension        | L40     | Independent; entirely new passage | Retrieval, vocabulary, inference, analysis, evaluation | Unit task - Coef. 2     |

### Non-negotiables for the final reading paper

- The passage must not be one of the four core stories, a Week 6 practice text, The Pedestrian, or a passage known to have been used with the cohort.
- Questions should sample explicit retrieval, vocabulary in context, inference with evidence, language/structure analysis and a brief evaluative judgement.
- Marks and expected answer length must be transparent. Do not let a long retrieval section outweigh analysis.
- Moderate the paper against the retained 2023/2024 materials, but do not simply recycle them.

### Suggested reading-paper balance

| Strand                | Suggested share | What success looks like                        |
|-----------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Retrieval / sequence  | 20%             | Accurate selection, concise response           |
| Vocabulary in context | 15%             | Meaning justified by local context             |
| Inference / character | 25%             | Evidence plus defensible reasoning             |
| Language / structure  | 30%             | Precise method, quotation and explained effect |
| Evaluation            | 10%             | A supported, qualified judgement               |

#### Marking principle

Reward accurate reading and clear explanation. Do not require one paragraph formula, a predetermined interpretation or technique-spotting without analysis.

# Differentiation without lowering the ceiling

The cohort is native or near-native, so differentiation should mainly alter access, rehearsal and degree of independence - not replace ambitious texts with low-level worksheets.

| Need       | Support                                                                                | Stretch                                                                      |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vocabulary | Preselect 5-7 words; morphology/context routine; bilingual gloss only where essential. | Track connotation, semantic field and shifts in register.                    |
| Inference  | Evidence bank; because/therefore stems; oral rehearsal before writing.                 | Require competing interpretations and qualification.                         |
| Analysis   | One short passage; highlight choice/effect; live model.                                | Analyse pattern, structural placement and reader positioning.                |
| Writing    | Sensory bank, paragraph route, targeted checklist, extra planning minutes.             | Constrain adjective use; require motif, tonal shift or controlled ambiguity. |
| Assessment | Standard access arrangements only; chunk instructions, not content clues.              | Extension question after the assessed paper, kept outside the mark total.    |

## Weekly operating rhythm

Across seven lessons, preserve variety: two substantial reading lessons, two close-analysis lessons, one discussion/performance lesson, one analytical-writing lesson and one retrieval/checkpoint lesson. Not every lesson needs a worksheet. Students should annotate the text, think aloud, talk, write and revise.

## Preparation checklist

- Extract the exact anthology pages for each core story.
- Verify the All Summer in a Day hyperlink and secure a legal classroom copy.
- Check whether House in the Mist or any retained past paper is genuinely unseen to this cohort.
- Build one shared annotation key and use it all term.
- Prepare the descriptive-writing rubric before Week 5.
- Commission a new unseen passage and paper before Week 6.
- Build the projector-ready IWB toolkit lesson by lesson from this sequence; do not import the dated PPT decks wholesale.

### Final recommendation

Keep the archive, but teach from a deliberately tiny core. Four stories, two transfer passages, one mock and two final tasks are enough. Everything else should have to justify its existence.

## Source note

Resource decisions are based on inspection of the supplied 216-file Short Stories archive and the unit-outline image. Curriculum alignment uses the Department for Education's currently published KS3 English programme of study. The announced replacement curriculum is due to be published in spring 2027 for teaching from September 2028.